Out of the box vs customization

Row-by-row read of the Syneos Japan and Executive Recruiting feasibility tables (Groups 1, 2, and 3).

Checked against CRM product knowledge and local code through 26 October 2026. Local clones cover messaging, automations, jobs UI, LinkedIn workflows, and the recruiter dashboard. Departmentalization, Agency Portal, CMS, and sourcing services were read from the engineering index and product docs.

2	5	6	13	1
Out of the box	Configuration	Partial	Customization	Discovery only

How to read the verdict

- Out of the box: the capability is already in the product for this use.
- Configuration: it exists. The work is tenant setup, entitlement, or quality tuning.
- Partial: a narrower version is available. The customer's full ask is not.
- Customization: new product, integration, language, or data-model work.
- Discovery only: a time-boxed spike, not a delivery commitment.

Group 1. Available now or close to it

CRM departmentalization / data segregation

Configuration

Departmentalization is a shipped CRM scope feature (crm-commons scope filters; candidate visibility by user, job, project, and event). A Japan dispatch versus TSP firewall is tenant design, not a new product. A July 2026 architecture note still flags ALL-scope leak paths, so the firewall needs a design review before it can be promised as airtight.

Search candidates by skills

Out of the box

Skills search is already in the product: boolean and advanced search, the filters panel, and Sourcing Agent query extraction all treat skills as a search attribute. This does not cover Kanji, Hiragana, and Katakana folding or a project-level fit score.

Sourcing Agents / Intelligent Sourcing

Configuration

Both exist. Jobs UI mounts a Sourcing Agent outlet, and the July 2026 search documentation treats Intelligent Sourcing, Xplus, and Sourcing Agent as live surfaces over the same profile search. Executive-search quality still needs tenant tuning. Japanese candidate coverage is a data and region question.

LinkedIn connectivity

Configuration

LinkedIn CRM Connect is in code: crm-workflows syncs projects, stages, and resumes with LinkedIn. Candidate records also carry a LinkedIn profile URL. Recruiter System Connect for this tenant is an entitlement and contract check.

Nurture and candidate communications

Out of the box

Email, SMS, and WhatsApp campaigns, templates, inbox, and automation actions (send email, send SMS, add to campaign) are in the messaging platform. Japanese UI copy, Japanese dynamic content, and WeChat messaging sit outside this foundation.

Client portal pages via CMS landing pages

Partial

CMS landing pages are an existing career-site capability, so a branded client page can be configured. Hiring automations, apply flow, client logos, and self-service page building are not one out-of-the-box package.

Agency Portal access

Partial

An Agency Portal exists: jobs UI loads crm-agency-ui, and a September 2026 product note describes job assignment, scoped submissions, and agency attribution. Heavy agency volume, multiple clients, Japanese agent workflows, and blocking when a candidate is already in the database are not confirmed as configuration alone.

WeChat candidate / source data

Partial

WeChat shows up as a profile and source marker (jobs UI has WeChat profile icons). A September 2026 product explanation describes China job-post and apply through a China data center, then CRM follow-up on email or SMS. The messaging platform has no WeChat channel.

Japanese resume parsing / candidate-language handling

Partial

Parser and fit-score language coverage for Japanese is a product claim and was not verified in the local clones. Jobs UI already ships a Japanese string catalog. That is separate from a Japanese recruiter CRM. Syneos describes their CRM UI as still English.

Group 2. Pilot commitments for the next 3 to 4 months

Constrained Japan + Executive Recruiting pilot

Configuration

The pieces to assemble a pilot already exist: departmentalization, projects, skills search, sourcing, intake, interview guides, email and SMS nurture, and recruiter dashboard project context. The work is tenant hierarchy, roles, and which fields are in scope.

Scoped hiring-manager / external-user access

Partial

Hiring Manager experience, project roles, and hiring-manager account provisioning exist. A named, project-scoped, manually approved external user can be piloted. Unrestricted non-Syneos access, automatic role sync, and the audit model Syneos security would accept are not out of the box.

Structured project intake and interview-guide workflow

Configuration

Jobs UI already mounts Xplus intake and intake-agent insights. Interview guides live in Interview Management. An agreed template stored against a project is configuration if the project can hold that artifact. External logins for I/O psychologists and MDs are the access row, not this one.

Project-level fit assessment

Partial

Job-level fit score is shipped: jobs UI loads the fit-score micro-frontend and a matching-criteria dialog for experience, location, and skills. A project-level score with a customer-defined threshold, audit trail, and Japanese-script handling is additional scope.

Project-level weekly funnel reporting

Customization

Recruiter dashboard can look up project context. The cloned analytics services do not expose a weekly report that joins project, requisition, stage, source, agency, and conversion under row-level security. That report has to be defined and built or modeled.

Japanese localization increment, not full parity

Customization

Jobs UI already includes Japanese in its locale list and a Japanese message file. Active work (PHEM-2486436, PHEM-2491710) translates specific job fields toward career sites, including Japanese, for another customer. A Syneos pilot language pack for CRM navigation and candidate, job, and project fields is still a translation project.

Integration feasibility spikes

Discovery only

Salesforce business-development sync, a WeChat operating model, and the named Japanese boards have no committed connector in the reviewed code or docs. A time-boxed yes, no, and effort spike is the right next step. It is not a delivery commitment.

Group 3. Full scope is not a near-term commitment

Full end-to-end Japanese localization

Customization

CRM UI, dynamic content, communications, every module, resume parsing, and AI agents are separate surfaces. Japanese exists in pieces (jobs UI strings, parser-language claims, one career-site field epic). Full parity is a multi-team program. Syneos recruiters are described as working in an English CRM today.

Cross-script search (Kanji, Hiragana, Katakana)

Customization

Skills and boolean search do not normalize Japanese scripts. No product or code evidence was found for transliteration-aware candidate search. This needs new indexing and ranking work.

Multilingual candidate identity resolution

Customization

Candidate merge exists as a CRM operation, and agency attribution is documented at application level. Recognizing the same person across Japanese scripts while keeping requisition history, original source, and agency attribution is a matching and data-model build.

WeChat candidate communication

Customization

Messaging channels in code are email, SMS, WhatsApp, and voice. There is no WeChat send, inbox, or opt-in. China job-post and apply is a different architecture from recruiter two-way chat.

Japanese-language offer and onboarding support

Customization

Offer objects exist on the hiring-manager profile services. No verified Japanese offer, background-check, or onboarding flow was found. The customer described this as an external handoff. Localizing that handoff is new scope.

All named Japanese job boards

Customization

Bizreach, Indeed Japan, kyujin box, doda, Tokon, and OpenWork do not appear as connectors. The 22 October Japan call describes board distribution as manual, with no trackable apply-back. Each board is a partner integration.

Dynamic Digital Search Book

Customization

Sourcing can produce a candidate slate. No product artifact matches a live, client-facing, refreshing search book. A permissioned export of an existing slate is a workaround. The dynamic book itself is new design and build.

Client portal with automations, apply, logos, and self-service build

Customization

A CMS landing page can be configured. Combining hiring automations, apply workflow, per-client logos, and client self-service authoring is a package that does not exist as one feature.

Unrestricted non-Syneos hiring-manager access

Customization

Role and project visibility exist. Open access for every external hiring manager does not, and Syneos security has already said that model is not acceptable. Only the named, least-privilege pilot in Group 2 is credible.

Agency use across multiple clients

Customization

One agency cohort on assigned jobs, with application-level attribution, is the current portal. A workspace where one agency user handles many clients without seeing another client's database is not a confirmed operating model.

Salesforce BD API / contact integration

Customization

No active CRM connector, object map, or owner was found for a Salesforce business-development contact sync. This stays a discovery item until the system of record and API contract are named.

Evidence boundary

Source document: Syneos Japan and Executive Recruiting Feasibility Working Doc, 23 October 2026. Code citations are from local clones of crm-jobs-ui, crm-messaging-platform, crm-workflows, and the recruiter dashboard. Messaging channels confirmed in code are email, SMS, WhatsApp, and voice. Departmentalization, Agency Portal behavior, CMS landing pages, and sourcing-agent services were not re-read from those service repositories in this pass.